

Ambizione Call 2026

Guidelines for submitting a proposal via mySNF

Submission deadline: 3 November 2026

(Version: 11.08.2026, updates in paragraph 1, 2.10, 2.17, 3.2)

Table of contents

1.	Aim of Ambizione	2
2.	Submission of proposal and evaluation	2
2.1	Regulations and relevant documents	2
2.2	Personal requirements and extension of the eligibility window	2
2.3	Next deadline	2
2.4	Parallel submissions	3
2.5	Create a new application on mySNF	3
2.6	Duration of the grant	3
2.7	Earliest and latest possible starting date for the grant	3
2.8	Revised application	3
2.9	Gross salary of the applicant	3
2.10	Budget limit for project funds and what may be requested	4
2.11	Data Management Plan	5
2.12	Exclusion of external reviewers	5
2.13	Cover letter and career plan	5
2.14	Eligible research institutions	5
2.15	Choice of research institution	5
2.16	Written confirmation of the research institution	5
2.17	Letters of collaboration	6
2.18	Evaluation procedure	6
2.19	Evaluation panels	7
3.	Instructions for CV, major achievements and statement of mobility	7
3.1	General remarks	7
3.2	CV and major achievements	7
3.3	Statement of mobility	8
4.	Instructions for the research plan	9
4.1	General remarks	9
4.2	Travel advice and safety risk	10
4.3	Structure and content of the research plan	10

1. Aim of Ambizione

In this career stage, you will carry out an independent research project in Switzerland. An Ambizione grant comes after a postdoctoral period, during which you have acquired sufficient experience so that you are ready to conduct independent research yourself. **Ideally:**

- You should have at least one major research output independent from your work as a PhD student and the associated PhD supervision framework. This research output will be judged against the norms of your discipline. If you hold a medical degree, you should have at least one major research output independent from your first work period as researcher. This research output will be judged against the norms of your discipline.
- Where necessary, you have complemented your expertise with appropriate collaborations.
- You may request the **salaries of employees** (e.g. technicians or support personnel/scientific assistants). You must have the required expertise to guide the tasks of the employees who will support you in your research project. However, doctoral students (pursuing an MD, MD-PhD or PhD) or postdocs cannot be employed. **Note that the support provided for the applicant's project by the research institution or by third party funding should also be limited to employees (e.g. technicians or support personnel/scientific assistants).**

After Ambizione, you will be ready for a scientific or academic career, or for a position in industry or the public sector.

2. Submission of proposal and evaluation

2.1 Regulations and relevant documents

The Ambizione Regulations and relevant documents are available on the SNSF website in [German](#), [French](#) and [English](#) (see section "Documents"). Alternatively, the documents are also accessible in your Ambizione application on mySNF under "Information/Documents". For any questions contact: ambizione@snf.ch

2.2 Personal requirements and extension of the eligibility window

The personal requirements for applicants, including **eligibility window and a proven record of research activities of at least 12 months in a research environment**, are governed by article 5 of the Ambizione Regulations. For applicants with PhD, the date of the examination or viva voce/defence of the thesis is the decisive date. For applicants who have completed their medical studies and plan to have clinical activity during the grant, the date of the medical exam (Staatsexamen or equivalent exam) is relevant (regardless of whether they also have a PhD). An extension of the eligibility window is governed by the [General Implementation Regulations for the Funding Regulations](#) (see Clause 1.11). Professors in permanent or temporary employment are not eligible for Ambizione.

2.3 Next deadline

There is only one call per year. The call opens approximately 3 months before the deadline. Proposals have to be submitted electronically via the web platform mySNF (www.mysnf.ch). The application must be submitted **before 17:00:00 Swiss local time (i.e. UTC + 1)** on the day of the submission deadline:

Opening call 2026: **3 August 2026**

Submission deadline call 2026: **3 November 2026**

2.4 Parallel submissions

Note that an Ambizione application may only be submitted for a duration of support for which no other project grants (as applicant or co-applicant), Sinergia grants, SPIRIT grants or programmes of the SNSF have been requested, approved or are ongoing. For career funding schemes, parallel applications may only be submitted for a Postdoc.Mobility return grant (see article 13 of the Ambizione Regulations).

2.5 Create a new application on mySNF

All new users have to register first on mySNF (www.mysnf.ch). In the corresponding step during the registration, make sure to select the correct division and funding instrument (**Careers/Ambizione**). Note that it may take several days to process your request for a mySNF account. If you already have a mySNF account, check that the role "grant applicant" is present. Before making any entries or uploading files, make sure to read all information in this document as well as in the header of every container carefully.

2.6 Duration of the grant

Ambizione grants are awarded for a maximum of four years. The minimum duration of funding is two years. If less than the maximum duration of the grant is requested, the applicant must explain the shorter duration in the container "General remarks on the project".

2.7 Earliest and latest possible starting date for the grant

For a submission on 3 November 2026, the earliest and latest possible starting dates are 1 September 2027 and 1 September 2028, respectively. Note that the starting date can still be changed within this window after an Ambizione grant has been awarded.

2.8 Revised application

Pursuant to article 14 of the Ambizione Regulations, applicants whose application was rejected **may apply at the most a second time** for an Ambizione grant regardless of the subject matter of the project, as long as the applicant still fulfils all personal requirements.

All submissions are treated equally, independent whether an applicant has applied before or not. Applicants may revise and resubmit an unsuccessful application but can no longer declare it as a resubmission. As consequence, researchers are not required to state in writing how the reasons for rejection have been considered in the revised proposal. This adjustment ensures that all applications are treated equally. However, researchers are still expected to adapt their projects, taking the reasons for rejection into consideration.

2.9 Gross salary of the applicant

The SNSF awards **Ambizione grants** and **Ambizione project grants**. Pursuant to article 1 paragraph 4 of the Ambizione Regulations, grantees must devote their entire work time (100%) to the planned research. A lower work time percentage of at least 80% is permissible (see article 6 paragraph 1 of the Ambizione Regulations).

The SNSF acknowledges that family care duties are not always compatible with a full-time employment. Thus, working part-time (min. 0.8 FTE) while being paid by an SNSF grant is possible. In order to give grantees working part-time due to family care duties the opportunity to extend the duration of the funding period, all grantees should be aware of the possibility of planning and submitting their application with a

full-time employment. Grantees may request to change their worktime percentage at any time upon approval of the grant.

Ambizione grant: The grant covers project funds and the full salary of the grantee. An Ambizione grant is not intended to cover just a share of the salary of the grantee. **Make sure to add a corresponding entry/expense in the budget on mySNF.** The average gross salary will be around CHF 115'000 per annum for a work time percentage of 100% (e.g. research associate level, junior group leader, scientific collaborator, etc.). The social security contributions of the employer will be covered as well. If you would like to insert more accurate figures for the salary, contact in advance the HR department or the personnel office of the research institution. The exact salary must be confirmed by the research institution at the latest for approved grants.

The fields labelled "Social security contributions (%)" are automatically calculated according to the selected research institution in the container "University or research institution".

Family/child allowance ("Further social security contributions") differ in every canton. Therefore, contact in advance the HR department or the personnel office of the research institution.

For researchers doing clinical work: The salary share dedicated to research (at least 80%) is covered by the Ambizione grant. The salary share for the work-time percentage dedicated to clinical work (up to 20%) must be covered by your employer.

Ambizione project grant: The grant comprises project funds only. The salary of the grantee is fully covered by the research institution.

2.10 Budget limit for project funds and what may be requested

The budget limit for project funds is **CHF 250'000 for 4 years**, i.e. an average of CHF 62'500 per annum. The budget should be as detailed as possible (e.g. separate entries are required for equipment, access costs to infrastructure, consumables, travel, support personnel, etc.). **Note that the overall costs for equipment and material of enduring value cannot exceed CHF 100'000** (see [General implementation regulations for the Funding Regulations Art. 2.8](#)). Costs for **open access publications** are not eligible costs under Ambizione grants and must be applied for separately via mySNF (for details see: [Open Access to Publications](#)). Changes in the budget after the submission of the application are not possible. For more details see articles 10 and 11 of the Ambizione Regulations.

Pursuant to article 9 of the Ambizione Regulations, a **research stay of no more than 12 months** at a Swiss or foreign academic host institution or at an institution of the practical realm (industry, administration, etc.; intersectoral mobility) can be envisaged as part of the Ambizione grant. The mandatory documents for such a stay include a letter of invitation and a detailed budget of the costs.

Project funds may be used to employ support personnel (e.g. technicians or scientific assistants). However, doctoral students (pursuing an MD, MD-PhD or PhD) or postdocs cannot be employed. **Note that the support provided for the applicant's project by the research institution or by third party funding should also be limited to support personnel.**

Personnel salaries may differ between institutions. The applicant should therefore contact in advance the HR department or the personnel office of the research institution for the corresponding salary standards.

2.11 Data Management Plan

A Data Management Plan (DMP) is requested for approved grants according to the requirements issued by the SNSF. Funds can only be released once the DMP has been submitted. Missing or inaccurate statements in the DMP need to be added/revised at the latest before the release of the payment of the second instalment. A definitive and updated version of the DMP must be provided by the end of the funding period. For more details on the DMP format requirements and procedure see:

[Data Management Plan \(DMP\) - Guidelines for researchers](#)

Please note that costs for Open Research Data (ORD) must be taken into account at the time of submission of the application. They cannot be covered by a supplementary grant.

2.12 Exclusion of external reviewers

The applicant is entitled to submit together with the proposal a list with the names and addresses of **persons who are not to be asked** for an external review (exclusion list). The SNSF may abide by this list if the applicant provides a valid reason for the requested exclusion and if a sufficient number of other experts is available.

2.13 Cover letter and career plan

A cover letter and a career plan are no longer required. Uploaded files will be deleted.

2.14 Eligible research institutions

All publicly funded research institutions in Switzerland are eligible, i.e. universities, university hospitals, universities of applied sciences, universities of teacher education, research centres (e.g. PSI, EMPA, EAWAG) or institutes of postgraduate education (e.g. IDIAP, IHEID).

2.15 Choice of research institution

The suitability of the chosen research institution and the mobility are assessment criteria (see articles 9 and 15 of the Ambizione Regulations). Justify the choice of the research institution in the document "Statement of Mobility" (see paragraph 3.3). **The choice must be carefully motivated, in particular for the following cases:**

- At the time of the submission deadline the applicant has already spent more than one year at their present Swiss research institution.
- The applicant has already spent more than one year as postdoctoral researcher in the past at the selected research institution.
- The applicant would like to return to the research institution where they received their PhD or completed their medical exam.
- The applicant would like to join the research institution of their PhD advisor.

2.16 Written confirmation of the research institution

Applicants must contact as soon as possible the research institution to ask for the written confirmation of the research institution. The written confirmation of the research institution consists of two separate letters:

1. Detailed confirmation of the research institution signed by the contact person (leader of the research group) mentioned in the application and the head of the institute/department. This letter refers to the obligations which are stated in the Ambizione Regulations, in particular article 8.

2. General confirmation of the vice rectorate for research (or equivalent).

The directorate of the institute/department must forward the detailed confirmation of the research institution (point 1) to the vice-rectorate for research in order to receive the general confirmation (point 2). Both confirmations should be sent to the applicant for a timely submission of the application.

Both confirmations must follow the text template provided by the SNSF and include the official letterhead of the research institution. They must be added to the application and will only be regarded as complete if all the points relevant to the application are addressed. The text template is available in [German](#), [French](#) and [English](#).

2.17 Letters of collaboration

According to the [San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment \(DORA\)](#) signed by the SNSF, applications are evaluated based on the quality of past and ongoing research activities. Following this principle, the SNSF does not rely on third party opinions. **However, to facilitate the evaluation of the feasibility of the project, each collaborator should provide a letter confirming their collaboration**, which limits itself to a statement about the collaboration and refrains from highlighting the qualifications of the applicant or the merits of the project. Letters of collaboration are uploaded under "Other annexes".

Support/Reference letters highlighting the qualifications of the applicant or the merits of the project, which are uploaded in the application or forwarded to the SNSF by mail/email, will be discarded.

2.18 Evaluation procedure

The evaluation procedure takes place in two phases. In phase 1, the Research Council of the SNSF makes an initial selection based on the documents submitted. Applicants rejected in phase 1 as well as applicants selected for phase 2 will receive a preliminary information in the beginning of April 2027. The official decision for rejected applicants will follow around mid-May 2027.

Applications selected for phase 2 are peer-reviewed. All applicants selected for phase 2 are invited to an interview to present their research project. The presentation is followed by Q&A session with the panel. The interviews are held in June. The interviews are scheduled on the following days:

Panels SSH: 9/10 June 2027

Panels MINT: 17/18 June 2027

Panels LS: 3/4 June 2027

Applicants will receive a preliminary information about the outcome of phase 2 around mid-July 2027. The official decision letter with detailed information will follow in early August 2027. For more details on the evaluation procedure see:

[Evaluation procedure – this is how we select](#)

The SNSF subjects all applications for an Ambizione grant to a stringent scientific evaluation procedure and rates them based on pre-defined criteria at its due discretion. Based on assessments by referees and co-referees and the comparison and discussion of applications by an evaluation panel, a small

share of applications may emerge that are of equal quality and equally worthy of funding. As no further differentiation is possible, decisions for this group of applications will be reached by drawing lots according to Article 19 paragraph 7 of the [Organisational Regulations of the Research Council](#). Applicants affected by this procedure are informed in the decision letter.

2.19 Evaluation panels

Lists of active members for the different Ambizione evaluation panels are available on the SNSF website. It is possible that for certain applications, members from different panels are assigned to cover the disciplinary diversity as far as possible.

3. Instructions for CV, major achievements and statement of mobility

3.1 General remarks

The SNSF has signed the [San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment \(DORA\)](#), which recommends funders to be explicit about the criteria used in evaluating the scientific productivity of applicants. The scientific quality, value and impact of different research outputs (including datasets, software, prototypes, research publications) in the major achievements are taken into consideration. In this context, the scientific content of a paper is much more important than publication metrics or the name of the journal in which it was published. Within the scope of the evaluation, the scientific discipline and the academic age (incl. career breaks, care duties, etc.) of the applicant will be considered.

3.2 CV and major achievements

The SNSF defined a new structure for the CV and requests a standardised set of information from all applicants. **Specifically, applicants will have to compile their CV and major achievements according to a template on the SNSF Portal and subsequently upload a PDF in the data container "CV and major achievements".**

For more details on the new CV format see: [Your curriculum vitae – all about the CV format](#)

The portal can be accessed under: portal.snf.ch

The major achievements do not need to be linked to your current application or directly relevant to it. The idea is for you to give a general description of your most important research to date. Your scientific qualifications will be evaluated mainly on the basis of your input and the associated works. **Include a brief description of your own contribution in referenced publications.** Competences that are relevant for the project should be stated primarily in the research plan.

An ORCID will be required and communicated to those conducting the evaluation (panel members and reviewers). **Therefore, make sure that the publicly accessible content of your ORCID profile is up-to-date.**

This information is intended for evaluators to specifically assess the scientific quality and relevance of the research output. The CV and major achievements must be written in the language of the research plan or in English. The document is sent out for peer-reviewing and will be accessible for your research institution. **Note that the CV cannot be updated after the submission of your application.**

For applicants with an MD: An ongoing residency or a board certificate should be listed in the "Education/Qualifications" section of the CV.

If your PhD thesis is a monograph, please comment in the container "General remarks on the project" on the status of the PhD thesis publication. State whether the PhD thesis monograph is published or specify if the PhD thesis is submitted and when the publication is expected (a corresponding contract/agreement with the publisher should be uploaded in the container "Other annexes").

3.3 Statement of mobility

Mobility is recognised as a necessary factor for a successful scientific or academic career. In order to assess the applicant's past and planned mobility concept, a **statement of mobility** is required.

Academic mobility is defined in five dimensions including physical mobility but also more qualitative aspects of academic mobility such as collaborations or interdisciplinarity. You may enter your past mobility as well as the planned mobility during the funding period. Focus mainly on the experience after your PhD or medical exam. Structure your statement of mobility according to the dimensions listed in the form (not all dimensions are expected to be filled in).

1. Institutional academic mobility is the summary of institutional collaborations being beneficial to your career goals. These may be on a national level or even within the same research institution providing, for instance, complementary expertise, or additional infrastructure.

■ Show the added value to your career trajectory so far and to the proposal. The choice of the higher education institution where the grant will be hosted should be carefully motivated, if:

- you have spent more than one year as postdoctoral researcher at this institution;
- you return to the institution where you received your PhD degree or medical degree;
- you join the institution of your PhD advisor.

2. Transnational academic mobility refers to academic travel and exchange across borders of states. It is understood in terms of the roles of researchers in teaching-learning experiences as well as knowledge production and transfer.

■ Describe the benefits and lasting effects of a stay abroad (incl. several short-term stays over a certain time period), of collaborations or of your involvement in academic networks. The latter may include also involvement in border-crossing networks without active travel.

3. Intersectoral mobility: The scientific and technological challenges facing today's researchers are extremely complex and, in many cases, require new approaches to research and training.

■ Enter experience in the public, private and non-profit sectors relevant for the proposed research and explain its contribution.

4. Interdisciplinary mobility is the move across research fields different from your core discipline.

■ Explain where, when and how you did involve different disciplines in your research or plan to do so.

5. Intellectual mobility is the capacity to communicate research to a broader public (e.g. science communicator, contributions to the standing of science in society, translation into practice).

■ State how you are committed to sharing your knowledge beyond academia.

Please use the [form provided](#), comment on each of these dimensions where applicable, and consider the following points:

- Comment on the choice of your research institution in Switzerland with regard to its suitability to provide scientific support for your project as well as the possibilities to develop your intellectual background and your scientific independence.
- Address all dimensions prospectively and retrospectively. The ultimate goal is to present your past mobility and your planned mobility during the funding period.
- Your statement may contain information for all dimensions, but this is not mandatory.
- If it was not possible to perform any mobility before the submission deadline, please comment in the container "General remarks on the project" on the reasons why and elaborate in the form on the measures you will take in order to close the gap.

The applicant's mobility will be assessed based on the statement provided. The mobility performed by the end of the grant will be assessed regarding the aim of the respective funding scheme. The statement will be rated on the background of the research plan, the CV and the choice of the research institution.

The form can be filled either in the language of the research plan or in English. Only use Adobe Acrobat Reader/Adobe Acrobat to open, edit and save the form, or to print the document and save your input in a new pdf file.

4. Instructions for the research plan

4.1 General remarks

The research plan provides the basis for the scientific evaluation, particularly of the quality of the proposed research project, i.e. its scientific relevance, topicality, originality, feasibility and the suitability of its methods. Together with the CV and the major achievements, the research plan also serves as a basis for assessing the researcher's scientific qualifications, particularly their expertise with regard to the project. The SNSF's requirements with regard to the form and content of the research plan help to ensure the comparability of applications. This is an important prerequisite for a comparative evaluation based on the principle of competition and for the equal treatment of all applicants.

The research plan must consist of original text that has been written by the applicant. A limited amount of text (or other material, graphs, etc.) by third parties or text published by the applicant is permissible in the sections concerning the state of research (2.1) and the state of personal research (2.2) as well as when describing standard methods. The quoted texts must be clearly designated as such (quotation marks or appropriate wording) and a verifiable source must be mentioned nearby and in the bibliography. The SNSF uses a special software to compare texts and analyse suspected cases of plagiarism. A number of universities have made such programs available to their students and employees. We recommend that you contact your institution for further information. For more details see the [SNSF policy on scientific integrity](#).

In **mathematics, natural and engineering sciences, biology, medicine, psychology, economics and political sciences**, applications have to be submitted **in English**. In all other research areas, applications can be submitted in English or in one of the official Swiss languages (preferably in German or French; for Italian please contact the Administrative Offices of SNSF first). **If requested by the SNSF,**

an English translation of the research plan must be submitted with the application or provided at a later stage in the evaluation process.

Special rules apply for political sciences. Researchers will still be able to submit proposals in an official Swiss language should this be justified for scientific reasons, particularly if working in a specific language is appropriate to the nature of the research topic.

The SNSF does not consider applications that **do not meet the requirements for the research plan, the formal requirements for applications** (article 14 of the [Funding Regulations](#)) and the **requirements for research integrity and good scientific practice** (article 15 of the [Funding Regulations](#)).

4.2 Travel advice and safety risk

The SNSF does not consider applications that involve the moving of a Swiss-based researcher to a zone with a significant and unacceptable safety risk.

In areas for which the safety risk is not considered to be very high or regionally limited, a condition will be attached to the decision and the responsibility/accountability for the safety of all project participants will be transferred to the grantee.

The feasibility of the research project is examined within the framework of the evaluation. If applicable, risk assessment considerations must be documented in the research plan (e.g. how the research will be carried out without travelling to countries with significant safety risk).

Travel advice from the [Federal Department of Foreign Affairs \(FDFA\)](#) contains assessments of possible risks and recommendations and is a useful and important source of information. For more details, see the SNSF website on [Research in crisis areas](#).

4.3 Structure and content of the research plan

The research plan must **not exceed 15 pages A4 paper size and 60'000 characters (with spaces)**. **The character count in mySNF is binding.** This includes the **title or title/cover page**, possible **table of contents, summary, footnotes** (explanatory notes or comments at the bottom of a page), **illustrations, formulae, tables**, but not the bibliography (list of sources/references at the end of the document). Note that a cover/title page or a table of contents is not required. A minimum of **point 10 font size** (e.g. Times New Roman; condensed fonts not allowed) and **1.5 line spacing** must be used. The research plan may not contain any annexed documents and must be uploaded as a single file. In the research plan and in the bibliography, references to articles are permitted, but not links to websites.

A character count check should be performed as follows: To avoid an incorrect character count, do NOT insert tables/text as images. To verify the character count, upload the research plan (without the bibliography) as a PDF to mySNF. **The character counter in mySNF is binding. Do NOT use Microsoft Word or any other word processor for the check.**

Note that the research plan cannot be updated after the submission of your application.

The research plan must be structured as follows:

Research Plan	
1. Summary	In the summary (maximum 1 page), present the background and rationale of the project, list its overall objectives and specific aims, mention the methods to be used, and briefly discuss the expected results and their impact for the field.
2. Proposed Research	
2.1 Current state of research in the field	Describe your project in the context of the current state of knowledge in your field. Make reference to the most important publications, particularly by other authors. Describe: - which previous insights provided the starting point and basis for the planned studies; - in which areas research is needed, and why; - which important, relevant research projects are currently underway in Switzerland and abroad.
2.2 Current state of personal research and required competences for the project	Present the research work you have already undertaken in the relevant field or in related fields, describe the results obtained so far as well as the relevance of these preliminary undertakings for your project. Also describe your competences that are relevant for the implementation of the project (e.g. methodology, languages and IT skills, etc.). Together with the CV, this information serves as a basis for assessing your scientific qualifications, particularly your expertise with regard to the project.
2.3 Detailed research plan	Based on the information provided under 2.1 and 2.2, specify the approach you are taking and the concrete objectives that you aim to achieve in the period of funding. The following points should be addressed: - describe the studies or experiments needed and/or envisaged to reach the set goals. Assess the risks involved and propose alternatives if necessary; - characterise existing sources and datasets and describe the data collection strategy and possible alternative strategies; - methods by which the research goals are to be reached (applicant and collaborations) and methods that first have to be developed; - explain the role and the planned work of each member of the research team (incl. applicant, support personnel and collaborations). Your description should be as detailed as necessary to enable an expert to assess whether your methodology is appropriate and your project feasible. Refer to the work described here in the budget you submit via mySNF. All requested support personnel must be justified.
2.4 Schedule and milestones	Compile a schedule that includes the most important milestones (e.g. table, Gantt chart, etc.). This plan should also indicate the main tasks with which the persons funded by the SNSF/involved in the project are to be entrusted.

2.5 Relevance and impact	Describe the scientific relevance and expected impacts of your project for the discipline and for science as a whole (research and education/teaching). Mention the form in which you wish to publish your research results (articles in scientific journals, monographs, conference proceedings, etc.). Indicate whether and to what extent the proposed project will have a broader impact and what this impact will be.
2.6 Relevance for personal career development	Briefly explain why you are at a career stage where you are ready to embark on a new independent research project that will broaden your profile and how the Ambizione grant will contribute to your development in this direction.
3. Bibliography	List the sources of all works referred to in the research plan, including a Digital Object Identifier (DOI) where possible. Give the full reference, especially the title, source and full author list. Do not use "et al." to shorten the author list. (Exception: the author list can be shortened if a publication involves large international consortia with over 50 authors). The bibliography is not included in the maximum number of pages (15) and characters (60'000) count.